

TENTATIVE RULINGS

DEPT. CM7

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TENTATIVE RULING

Date: 01/07/2026

Case #	Case Name	Tentative
		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.:1 Date: 01/07/2026
		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.:2 Date: 01/07/2026
		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.:3 Date: 01/07/2026

		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.:4 Date: 01/07/2026
		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.:5 Date: 01/07/2026
01534015	Brennan – MC	TENTATIVE RULING Case: 01534015 Calendar No.:6 Date: 01/07/2026 MOTION TO SEAL (ROA 4) Plaintiff Jane Doe 1, a minor, moves for an order permanently sealing the unredacted Petition for Minor’s Compromise (ROA 3) filed with the court on 12/16/25. The motion is unopposed. Unless confidentiality is required by statute or rule of court, California court records are presumed to be open to the public. (Cal. Rules of Court, rule 2.550(c).) “Probate proceedings, including a petition for minor’s compromise, are not closed proceedings. No statute exempts probate files from the status of public records.” (<i>Copley Press, Inc. v. Superior Court</i> (1998) 63 Cal.App.4th 367, 376.) When individuals employ the public powers of state courts to accomplish private ends, “they do so in full knowledge of the possibly disadvantageous

		circumstance that the documents and records filed ... will be open to public inspection." (<i>Ibid.</i>) Absent circumstances not present here, the court may seal the records at issue only if it expressly finds facts establishing that: 1. There exists an overriding interest that overcomes the right of public access to the record; 2. The overriding interest supports sealing the record; 3. A substantial probability exists that the overriding interest will be prejudiced if the record is not sealed; 4. The proposed sealing is narrowly tailored; and 5. No less restrictive means exist to achieve the overriding interest. (Cal. Rules of Court, rule 2.550(d).) The party moving to have a record sealed bears the burden of proving such facts. (See <i>H.B. Fuller Company v. Doe</i> (2007) 151 Cal.App.4th 879, 894-895.) A public redacted version of the Petition for Minor's Compromise has been filed. (ROA 2.) The evidence before the court is sufficient to establish that there is an overriding interest that overcomes the right of public access to the nature and amount of the settlement, namely the privacy rights of the minor child. The evidence is also sufficient to establish a substantial probability that a failure to seal the requested portions will prejudice that overriding interest. The court finds the proposed sealing is narrowly tailored and no less restrictive means exists to achieve the overriding interests other than sealing the documents. The motion to seal is GRANTED. The court directs the clerk to permanently seal ROA 2. This order is without prejudice to the right of any person to seek an order unsealing the sealed document, or any portion thereof, pursuant to CRC, Rule 2.551(h). Moving party is directed to give notice.
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		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.:8 Date: 01/07/2026
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		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.:11 Date:

		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.:12 Date: [Hearing Month]
		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.: 13 Date:
		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.: Date:
		TENTATIVE RULING Case: Calendar No.: Date: [Hearing Month]

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